

JLR CRM Comparison

Summary

After comparing Little Green Light, Zeffy, and Givebutter, I believe Zeffy is the best choice for Junior League of Reading. It's free, provides robust native fundraising without fees, and makes outreach emails easy. Little Green Light has great record-keeping, but most functions require a lot of manual set-up and have a steep learning curve. Givebutter is comparable to Zeffy but far more expensive, without enough extra features to justify the cost.

	Little Green Light	Zeffy	Givebutter
Pricing	\$648/yr	Free	\$1,548/yr
Record-keeping	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Payment processing	★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Outreach	★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Fundraising	☆	★★★★★	★★★★★
Grant tracking	★★★★★	☆	☆
Technical	★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★

Comparison

Pricing

Little Green Light costs \$648/yr for up to 5k contacts, and \$810/yr for 5k-10k.. Zeffy is free but requests tips from donors. Givebutter has a free tier, but Plus is necessary for Quickbooks integration, data import, and the advanced email editor. Plus costs \$1,548/yr for up to 5k contacts; after that the price listing just says "talk to sales."

Record-keeping

Zeffy only offers Notes and Lists for custom data, while the others have custom fields and logs.

Payment processing

Zeffy and Givebutter have native, easy-to-build payment forms. Little Green Light requires more manual set-up, integration, and maintenance. All CRMs can integrate with Quickbooks.

Outreach

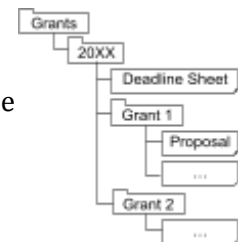
Little Green Light and Givebutter provide printable mail merge export. Zeffy and Givebutter allow you to send letters through their services for a fee (~\$1 each). Little Green Light's email editor seems difficult to use compared to Zeffy and Givebutter, and Zeffy provides the most detailed email performance metrics (such as how many people actually donated with the link in the email). Givebutter is by far the best for in-depth custom automations.

Fundraising

Little Green Light provides no native event creation or management. Zeffy and Givebutter do, and their options are extensive and comparable to one another. We would need an external service or a lot of extra, potentially hacky set-up to track this in LGL.

Grant tracking

LGL is the only service here with grant tracking. However, I think this could be done in Google Workspace, especially if we make a Google Calendar that updates from grant information input into a spreadsheet and set up the Drive folder like this:



Technical

Little Green Light has a lot of options, but they will require a lot of manual effort to set up and maintain. They don't have technical support on the weekends. Their documentation is comprehensive but not as easy to read and is sometimes poorly organized or rambling. Givebutter is extremely configurable and offers plenty of support (live and documented), but that's to be expected with how much they charge. Zeffy has 7-days-a-week support during ET business hours and good documentation, but fewer customization options.

Trade-offs

I do believe Zeffy is the best choice, but its biggest trade-offs are the limited options for custom fields and interaction logging, no soft credit attribution or non-cash gift reporting, no configurable-access roles or data backups, and tip nagging when users donate. Note that Givebutter, despite being far more expensive and extensive, has similar limitations.

Next steps

If Zeffy sounds good, once you [set up the account](#) I can start testing and/or migrating the data over. If you're still not sure, I can look into some other non-profit CRMs and report back.